

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 147

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to honor Troop B, 1st Squadron, 278th Armored Cavalry Regiment, Tennessee Army National Guard upon winning the 2024 Sullivan Cup Competition.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal safety and concerns to ensure our individual and collective freedom, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who have performed above and beyond the call of duty; and

WHEREAS, one such group of individuals is Ashland City's Troop B, 1st Squadron, 278th Armored Cavalry Regiment (ACR), Tennessee Army National Guard (Bonsai), whose soldiers recently claimed first place during the U.S. Army's 2024 Sullivan Cup Competition at Fort Moore, Georgia; and

WHEREAS, held every two years and hosted by the U.S. Army Maneuver Center, the Sullivan Cup pits the best M1 Abrams tank and Bradley crews from the U.S. Army, U.S. Marine Corps, and foreign allies in a head-to-head competition to test a crew's maneuver, sustainment, and gunnery skills; and

WHEREAS, by the end of the multi-day competition, the 278th crew from Ashland City had defeated ten other teams, six from active-duty Army units and four from allied nations; and

WHEREAS, the members of the 1st Squadron, 278th ACR tank crew who claimed the Sullivan Cup are Staff Sergeant David Riddick, Sergeant Joshua Owen, Specialist Noah Eddings, and Specialist Seth Carter; and

WHEREAS, the soldiers of the 1st Squadron, 278th ACR were the only National Guard/non-active duty unit in the competition; these soldiers represented the Tennessee Army

National Guard and the Volunteer State well and for the next two years will be recognized nationally and internationally as the best M1 Abrams tank crew in the world; and

WHEREAS, from Andrew Jackson, Davy Crockett, Sam Houston, Alvin York, Mitchell Stout, Larry Taylor, and James Gardener to George S. Gillespie, Jr., George Jordan, and Harrison Collins, the first Tennessean to be awarded the Medal of Honor, the warrior ethos and tenacity of the Volunteer is remembered; this M1 Abrams crew has demonstrated that the long-time warrior ethos of the Tennessee Volunteer remains alive and well in Tennessee today; and

WHEREAS, this recent victory reflects not only the dedication, tenacity, and teamwork of Staff Sergeant Riddick, Sergeant Owen, Specialist Eddings, and Specialist Carter but also the excellence of the officer and non-commissioned officer leadership of the 278th ACR and the Tennessee Army National Guard, as well as those who provide administrative, maintenance, and supply support; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we recognize the brave and noble members of the 278th Armored Cavalry Regiment, as they have made untold and innumerable personal sacrifices to be living examples of the Regiment's motto, "I Volunteer, Sir," to preserve the liberties we enjoy today, and to bring great pride to the State of Tennessee through their recent victory; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Staff Sergeant David Riddick, Sergeant Joshua Owen, Specialist Noah Eddings, and Specialist Seth Carter of Ashland City's Troop B, 1st Squadron, 278th Armored Cavalry Regiment, Tennessee Army National Guard upon their first-place finish during the U.S. Army's 2024 Sullivan Cup Competition, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.